TrailTag - Trail conditions crowdsourcing app

Executive Summary

TrailTag is an app that lets hikers log trail conditions (mud, snow, downed trees) so others can plan better. Pre-launch; building MVP part-time.

Problem

Trail condition information is scattered across Facebook groups and outdated websites. We interviewed 12 local hikers; 10 said they check multiple sources before a hike.

Market

Competitors include AllTrails (strong at maps, reviews, and weaker on real-time conditions). Our initial target is three regional trail systems with about 400,000 visits per year, based on park service data.

Business Model

Free for users; revenue from outdoor gear affiliate links and regional tourism board sponsorships. We have no revenue, and we do not yet know whether the sponsorship interest is real; one tourism board has agreed to a meeting.

Financials & Funding Ask

Not raising money; requesting 10,000 USD micro-grant for a mapping API license and 6 months of hosting. Founder works full-time elsewhere.

Team

Founder is a software engineer; friend is a trail volunteer coordinator who will help recruit initial contributors.

Risks

Cold-start problem: app is useless without contributors. Plan is to seed with volunteers on one trail system first.